

4.1 Literary genres

In Literary genres, the texts are connected through a mainstream literary genre: either Aspects of tragedy or Aspects of comedy. Tragedy and comedy have a long tradition in literature, with their origins in the ancient world and with a specific emphasis on drama. Texts have been selected and grouped together because they share some of the common features of traditional tragic and comic drama while also offering some interesting variations. We are, therefore, looking at an older historical form and measuring later texts and their approaches to tragedy or comedy against a literary genre which is long established.

Students choose **one** of the following options:

- Option 1A: Aspects of tragedy
- Option 1B: Aspects of comedy

Students study **three** texts: **one** Shakespeare play, a **second** drama text and **one** further text. In addition to the compulsory Shakespeare play, **one** of the other two texts must be written pre-1900.

The paper for this component is closed book. Students are **not** permitted to take a copy of their set texts into the exam.